THE BIG IDEA – CASE STUDY 3

Context: national clothing retailer[1].

You work at a national clothing retailer. You've conducted a survey asking your customers and the customers of your competitors about various elements related to back-to-school shopping. You've analysed the data. You've found there are some areas where your company is performing well, as well as some areas of opportunity. In particular, there are inconsistencies in service levels across stores. Together with your team, you've explored some different potential courses of action for dealing with this and would like to recommend solving through sales associate training. You need agreement that this is the right course of action and approval for the resources (cost, time, people) it will take to develop and deliver this training.

THE BIG IDEA

WHO IS YOUR AUDIENCE?

(1) List the primary groups or individuals to whom you'll be communicating.

The executive team

(2) If you had to narrow to a single person, who would that be?

The head of retail

(3) What does your audience care about?

- *Having a highly profitable back-to-school shopping session,*
- *Making customers happy because happier customers spend more,*
- *Beating the competition.*

(4) What action does your audience need to take?

Agree that training is the right way to deal with inconsistent service levels and approve the resources (cost, time, people) it will take to make it happen.

WHAT IS AT STAKE?

What are the benefits if your audience acts in the way you want them to?

- *Better service levels = happier customers,*
- *Happier customers spend more, come back more often, tell friends about their positive experience.*

What are the risks if they do not?

- *No action could lead to negative word of mouth,*
- *People shopping with competitors,*
- *Reputational risk,*
- Lost revenue.

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FORM YOUR BIG IDEA

It should:

(1) Articulate your point of view,
(2) Convey what's at stake, and
(3) Be a complete (and single) sentence.

Let's invest in sales associate training to improve the in-store shopping experience and make the upcoming back-to-school season the best revenue generating one yet!